

Chapter 153-4

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20:27.

Sun Chengcheng glanced at the time. Only ten minutes left.

But Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu were still over there chatting as if no one else existed.

The only place at this banquet that met the conditions was the swimming pool outside the other door.

There were quite a few people standing over there now, all admiring the beautiful open-air starry ceiling.

Sun Chengcheng was secretly anxious inside. She had prepared for so long...

And she hadn't seen Lu Jiayi either. In this banquet hall, no one matching Lu Jiayi's description had appeared.

20:30.

Xu Qingzhu and Liang Shi were still sitting there, sometimes chatting and laughing, sometimes making little intimate gestures.

Sun Chengcheng had already gotten up and gone near the swimming pool.

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Qin Lishuang had smoked three cigarettes in the lounge. It was very choking.

Lu Jiayi frowned. "Stop smoking."

"I'm thinking." Qin Lishuang said, "Miss Lu, I wonder if you'd be willing to help?"

"No." Lu Jiayi refused. "I won't get involved in your affairs."

Qin Lishuang curved her lips into a light smile. "How boring."

Lu Jiayi neither agreed nor disagreed with her assessment.

"I'll go myself then." Qin Lishuang said, "Just don't try to stop me."

Lu Jiayi's hand, which had been lowered playing with her phone, paused. "Not necessarily."

Qin Lishuang was startled: "I trust Miss Lu won't be so meddlesome."

A game sound came from Lu Jiayi's phone—she had just cleared a level of Match-3¹. She turned off the phone screen, put the phone in her suit pocket, stood up and walked toward the door. "I'm leaving first."

"Don't." Qin Lishuang lightly applied a layer of lipstick to her lips, making her look even more alluring. "You stay here. I'll go."

After saying that, Qin Lishuang rummaged through her bag and pulled out a small packet of something, weighing it in her hand while revealing an evil smile.

"What's that?" Lu Jiayi asked casually.

Qin Lishuang curved her lips: "Just a little something that can make people lose their strength."

Lu Jiayi: "..."

Just as Qin Lishuang was about to leave, she heard Lu Jiayi say: "How despicable."

Qin Lishuang's footsteps paused. She didn't refute it, and left happily.

Only Lu Jiayi was left alone in the lounge. She opened the window and looked down. It was no different from the capital—all people holding wine glasses and socializing.

She had come here at the request of her younger aunt, to deliver something to Old Master Qin.

And to lay low for a while.

She had just had a fight with her eldest younger brother at home and had almost come to blows.

It was an impulsive moment, and she had given him ammunition to use against her, putting her in a passive position with her father.

So her younger aunt gave her an idea—retreat in order to advance.

She had come to Haizhou City overnight.

According to her younger aunt, the influential powers in Haizhou City were also tangled and complex. Taking this opportunity, she could get to know more people.

Her younger aunt had told her at the time to get close to Qin Lishuang and not to offend Qin Lishuang.

After arriving, she hadn't met Qin Lishuang many times, and had only gotten to know Qin Lishuang.

Probably because Qin Lishuang had too much free time.

But no matter what, she was still a direct descendant of the Lu family, the legally designated first heir.

If the Qin family and the Lu family were to marry, no matter how you looked at it, it was the Qin family reaching above their station.

Lu Jiayi didn't need to watch anyone's expression while she was here.

She really did look down on Qin Lishuang's conduct—too despicable. Although she wasn't an artist herself, she knew that even art had to have a baseline of human decency.

But a strong dragon cannot suppress a local snake². No matter what bastard things Qin Lishuang did, Old Master Qin would cover for her.

What did it have to do with her?

Lu Jiayi stood by the window enjoying the breeze for a while. Looking down, she happened to see two figures in blue.

Both of them were quite attractive, standing out in the crowd.

She couldn't see clearly with the naked eye, so Lu Jiayi took out her phone and snapped a photo.

After zooming in, she discovered it was actually the person she had met at the entrance of the art museum that day, along with the one in the photo Qin Lishuang had shown her earlier.

The person in real life was probably even more beautiful than in the photo.

Lu Jiayi closed the window and continued playing Match-3.

But after playing two rounds, she suddenly stood up.

That person she had met at the entrance of the art museum that day... had quite beautiful eyes.

Very similar to the eyes of her friend's fiancée.

If she remembered correctly, that fiancée should also be one of the top elites in Haizhou City.

It couldn't hurt to make an acquaintance.

Thinking this, Lu Jiayi got up and headed out.

Footnotes:

¹ Match-3: Refers to "消消乐" (xiāo xiāo lè), a popular puzzle game genre in China similar to Candy Crush where players match three or more identical items to clear them from the board.

² A strong dragon cannot suppress a local snake (强龙不压地头蛇): A Chinese proverb meaning that even a powerful outsider cannot easily overcome local powers who have established influence in their territory.